

Checklist:

Managing a Growing Team Checklist

Shift your perspective

- ☐ Move from a front-line view to a macro view.
- ☐ Spend time on vision, org design, delegation, and communication.
- ☐ Accept that management changes as the team grows.

Adjust how you manage

- ☐ Stop trying to support everyone only through direct involvement.
- ☐ Recognize when you have too many reports to stay deep in every detail.
- ☐ Find the right balance between diving in and stepping back.
- ☐ Pick and choose where your attention matters most.

Make truth easier to hear

- ☐ Assume people may hesitate to challenge you once you have authority.
- ☐ Explicitly invite dissent and disagreement.
- ☐ Reward people who tell you uncomfortable truths.
- ☐ Own your mistakes publicly.
- ☐ Use language that lowers the risk of speaking up.

Get better at context switching

- ☐ Prepare for meetings in advance.
- ☐ Build a reliable note-taking and task-management system.
- ☐ Create regular time for reflection.
- ☐ Accept that rapid context switching is part of the job.

Become more people-centric

- ☐ Spend less time proving individual expertise.
- ☐ Spend more time getting the best out of other people.
- ☐ Focus on hiring strong leaders.
- ☐ Build self-reliant teams.
- ☐ Communicate clearly and often.

Delegate well

- ☐ Treat delegation as a core leadership skill.
- ☐ Give people big problems as a sign of trust.
- ☐ Believe your reports can solve hard problems.
- ☐ Publicly clarify who owns what.
- ☐ Stay available to coach without taking the work back.

Build a shared vision

- ☐ Use 1:1s to help the other person, not for information-gathering.
- ☐ Align on top priorities.
- ☐ Align on people, purpose, and process.
- ☐ Keep reinforcing why the work matters.
- ☐ Help your managers establish healthy processes for their own teams.

Address weak management honestly

- ☐ Remember that a manager should be a positive multiplier.
- ☐ Notice when a manager is slowing projects, making poor calls, or blocking team growth.
- ☐ Judge based on outcomes, not just effort or intent.
- ☐ Ask: "Would I hire this person again for this role?"
- ☐ Make the hard move when the answer is no.

Put yourself out of a job

- ☐ Look for responsibilities that someone else can do as well as you or better.
- ☐ Delegate work that is important but not uniquely dependent on you.
- ☐ Invest your time where your unique value is highest.
- ☐ Keep expanding your leadership capacity year over year.

Use your unique leverage

- ☐ Identify and communicate what matters across the organization.
- ☐ Help hire top talent.
- ☐ Resolve priority conflicts between teams.
- ☐ Escalate decisions when your managers lack the full picture.

Keep growing with the team

- ☐ Expect your role to evolve as the team grows.
- ☐ Create stretch opportunities for your leaders.
- ☐ Keep taking on bigger, less familiar challenges.
- ☐ Measure success by how much more the whole team can achieve.